Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 9 2
♥ A J 4 3
♦ Q 7
♣ Q 10 6

♠ 7 6 5
♥ 8 5 2
♦ J 10 4
♣ 8 4 3 2

♠ 4
♥ 10 9
♦ A K 6 5 3 2
♣ J 9 7 5

♠ A K J 8 3
♥ K Q 7 6
♦ 9 8
♣ A K

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣3

You dealt this hand.

You aren't strong enough to open 2♣ so you bid 1♠. Partner responds 3♠.

Partner's limit-raise shows 11-12 points and you revalue your hand up to 22. So you are definitely in slam territory. You hope partner has 2 Aces but you cannot use Blackwood with that worthless doubleton in ♦s. Instead you make a control-showing bid of 4♣. Partner then bids 4♥.

The good news is that partner's control-showing bid says he has the ♥A. The bad news is that he bypassed ♦s so he does not have the ♦A. Since you may have 2 quick losers in ♦s you sign off at 4♠.

Board 2
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q 8 5 ♥ A K 4 ♦ K J 10 ♣ K 10 4 3	
♠ 10 2 ♥ 10 9 7 2 ♦ 4 3 2 ♣ A 9 7 5		♠ J 9 7 6 ♥ 5 3 ♦ Q 8 7 6 5 ♣ 8 2
	♠ A K 4 3 ♥ Q J 8 6 ♦ A 9 ♣ Q J 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1NT
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♣5

You have a textbook 1NT opener, so you open 1NT. Partner says 4NT.

THIS IS NOT BLACKWOOD. Partner's bid is the Quantitative 4NT. He has 16 points and is inviting you to bid slam if you have a maximum opener, but to pass with a minimum. Since your 17 point hand is at the top of the 1NT range you accept the invitation and bid 6NT.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ K Q J 8 3 ♥ K 8 7 6 4 ♦ 7 ♣ A K	
♠ 10 7 2 ♥ 10 ♦ 10 9 8 5 4 ♣ 8 6 4 2	N W E S	♠ A 5 ♥ Q 2 ♦ K 6 2 ♣ Q J 10 9 5 3
	♠ 9 6 4 ♥ A J 9 5 3 ♦ A Q J 3 ♣ 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♠2

You **COULD** make a Splinter Bid with this hand. You have a singleton ♦ and great trump support. However it is usually not worthwhile Splintering when you have the strong hand that will be taking control. Since what you really want to know is how many Aces partner has you just ask him with a 4NT bid. Partner answers 5♥.

Missing one Ace you bid 6♥.

Board 4
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 7 2
♥ Q 4
♦ A Q 8 4
♣ A 5 2

♠ 9 5
♥ J 7 5 3 2
♦ 10 7 3
♣ 9 8 7

♠ J 8
♥ A 10 9 6
♦ 9 6 2
♣ Q 10 4 3

♠ A 10 6 4 3
♥ K 8
♦ K J 5
♣ K J 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣7

You have a good hand, but not good enough to jump-shift at your first turn. So you respond 1♠. Partner now jumps to 3♠.

Partner has 16-18 points and ♠ support. It depends on the Aces so you bid 4NT. His answer is 5♥.

You are missing one Ace but 6♠ should be a good slam.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q J ♥ A J 4 ♦ A 10 5 3 ♣ J 10 8	
♠ 10 7 2 ♥ 9 8 6 2 ♦ 9 ♣ A 7 6 5 3		♠ 9 8 6 4 ♥ 10 7 3 ♦ 6 2 ♣ K Q 4 2
	♠ A 5 3 ♥ K Q 5 ♦ K Q J 8 7 4 ♣ 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♦
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♦ by South
Lead: ♣A

After toying with the idea of a jump to 6NT, or perhaps a Gerber 4♣, you decide to bid 3♦. Partner rebids 4♦ and it is your turn.

Time to check for Aces. You bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

Tempting though it may be it is too dangerous to try 6NT. So you bid 6♦ which turns out to be laydown while 6NT would have been down 4.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 10 7 4 2
♥ A K
♦ A
♣ K J 8 6 3

♠ 6
♥ Q 8 3 2
♦ K J 10 5 4 2
♣ 4 2

♠ —
♥ J 10 7 5
♦ Q 9 6
♣ A Q 10 9 7 5

♠ A Q J 9 8 5 3
♥ 9 6 4
♦ 8 7 3
♣ —

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	7♠		
All Pass			

7♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

You dealt this hand.

You decide to preempt 3♠ with this hand. Partner's eyes wobble and he jumps straight to 4NT.

With 1 Ace and a void in a lower-ranking suit you should bid 6 of that suit. So you bid 6♣. Partner jumps again, this time to 7♠. What do you b . . . oh never mind.